



English Composition I: Revising for Evidence — A Full Workshop Session

English Composition I • English/Writing

COURSE-OBJ.ENGL101.2

Identify unsupported generalizations in a draft paragraph and revise them into evidence-based analysis that explicitly connects evidence to a claim. A complete 90-minute session packet with warm-up, guided practice, partner/lab work, independent practice, extension work, assessment, and a full answer key.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan the session

Course and objective

English Composition I · English/Writing; COURSE-OBJ.ENGL101.2 — Revise a thesis-driven paragraph by replacing generalizations with specific evidence and explicit analysis connecting that evidence back to the claim.

What is included

Cover; instructor guide; key-term and concept preview; original reading or worked examples; warm-up (2 items); guided practice with organizer (4 items); partner/lab discussion (3 items); independent practice (6 items); small-group extension work (4 items); assessment; complete answer key; access and sources page.

Suggested pacing (90-minute session)

Warm-up 8 min · read both drafts + vocabulary 15 min · guided evidence/analysis organizer 18 min · partner revision workshop 18 min · independent practice 22 min · extension work 5 min · assessment 4 min.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from the answer key, or distribute through a secure LMS. Review the reading/examples and organizer before class. No paid textbook or app is required.

Student directions

Read or work through the material carefully. Support every answer with evidence, work shown, or clear reasoning.



Before you begin

Key terms

claim — the specific, arguable point a paragraph is making

evidence — a specific, checkable fact, quotation, or data point

analysis — the writer's explanation of how evidence supports a claim

generalization — a broad, vague statement with no specific evidence attached

quote-dropping — citing evidence without explaining how it proves the claim

circular writing — restating a claim in different words instead of supporting it

Concept focus

A strong body paragraph makes a specific claim, supports it with concrete evidence (a quotation, statistic, or detailed example), and then analyzes that evidence — explaining, in the writer's own words, how it proves the claim. A common early-draft weakness is the "unsupported generalization": a broad claim ("Social media affects teenagers a lot") with no specific evidence attached. Revision is not about adding more words; it is about replacing vague claims with specific evidence and adding analysis that explains why the evidence matters, rather than just dropping a quotation in and moving on ("quote-dropping").

Model 1 — Spotting an unsupported generalization

"Exercise is good for students." — This is too broad and has no evidence attached. A revised version names a specific effect and cites specific evidence: "Students who exercised for 30 minutes before a test scored 15% higher on average, according to a 2019 study of 200 undergraduates (Chen, 2019)."

Model 2 — Fixing quote-dropping with analysis

Weak: "The author writes 'the city forgot how to breathe' (12). This shows pollution is bad."

Revised: the same quotation is kept, but analysis is added explaining specifically how the metaphor of a city "forgetting to breathe" personifies pollution as a kind of suffocation, making an abstract environmental problem feel physically urgent to the reader.

WARM-UP

Warm-up

Answer using what you already know or recall from the previous session.

1. Identify one unsupported generalization from the "Before" paragraph and explain what specific information is missing from it.

2. What is the buried claim in the "Before" paragraph, and why is it difficult to find on a first read?



Draft Paragraph: Before Revision

Here is a student's early draft paragraph, written for an essay arguing that a particular city park should receive more funding for maintenance.

"Riverside Park is really important to the community. A lot of people use it every day, and it means a lot to different kinds of people. The park has been around for a long time and everyone has memories there. It would be sad if the park fell into disrepair because it matters so much to so many people. The city should definitely give the park more funding because it deserves it."

This paragraph has a claim buried in it (the park deserves more funding because it matters to the community), but every sentence supporting that claim is a generalization: "a lot of people," "means a lot," "for a long time," "matters so much." None of these phrases point to a specific, checkable piece of evidence a reader could verify or picture. The paragraph also never explains why community importance should translate into funding — it just repeats the claim in slightly different words each time, a pattern sometimes called "circular" writing.



Revised Paragraph: After Adding Evidence and Analysis

Here is the same paragraph after the student revised it using a city parks-department attendance report and a short interview with a local resident, replacing every generalization with something specific.

"Riverside Park served an estimated 40,000 visitors last year, according to the city parks department's 2025 attendance report — more than any other park in the district. That number includes a weekly farmers' market that brings in over 300 vendors and shoppers each Saturday, a youth soccer league with six teams, and, according to longtime resident Maria Ibarra, three generations of her own family who have picnicked there every summer since the park opened in 1987. This is not a park used occasionally by a few people; it is a piece of daily infrastructure for thousands of residents across different age groups and community roles, from small-business vendors to youth athletes to multigenerational families. Funding is directly tied to this scale of use: a facility serving 40,000 annual visitors carries a level of wear, from foot traffic to equipment use, that a city's general maintenance budget was never designed to absorb without a dedicated allocation."

Notice that the revision does not just add numbers for their own sake — each piece of evidence (the attendance figure, the market vendor count, the interview detail) is followed by analysis explaining specifically why that evidence supports the funding claim, rather than being dropped in and left to speak for itself.



Partner / lab discussion

Discuss each item with a partner or lab group before writing a joint response.

1. With a partner, revise this generalization into a specific, evidence-based sentence: "The cafeteria food is unhealthy." Invent plausible, clearly-labeled hypothetical evidence.

2. With a partner, discuss: why might the "After" paragraph's interview detail (three generations of one family) be more persuasive to some readers than the attendance statistic, even though it describes only one family?

3. Discuss: is it possible to over-rely on statistics and under-rely on human examples (or vice versa) in a paragraph like this? What would that look like?



Independent practice

Work independently. Show your work or cite evidence in every answer.

1. Rewrite this generalization into a specific claim with labeled hypothetical evidence and one sentence of analysis: "Online classes are convenient for students."

2. Identify the single most vague sentence in the "Before" paragraph, in your judgment, and explain your reasoning for choosing it over the others.

3. Explain how the "After" paragraph's topic sentence differs in function from its supporting sentences.



Independent practice

Work independently. Show your work or cite evidence in every answer.

4. A classmate revises their paragraph by adding three new statistics but no analysis sentences at all. Using the lesson's vocabulary, name the specific problem with this revision.

5. Write one original unsupported generalization (on any topic of your choice), then revise it into a specific, evidence-based sentence with labeled hypothetical evidence.

6. Add one sentence of analysis to the evidence-based sentence you just wrote, explaining how it supports your original claim.



Small-group extension work

Use for review or additional application practice.

1. Explain why "adding more words" is explicitly not the same as revision, according to the lesson.

2. Compare the "Before" and "After" paragraphs' final sentences. How does the function of the final sentence change between the two drafts?



Small-group extension work

Use for learners ready for additional challenge or synthesis.

1. Write a two-to-three sentence explanation, in your own words, of the difference between evidence and analysis, using an original example (not from this lesson).

2. Explain why a paragraph could have strong evidence but still fail as an argument if the analysis is missing.

Assessment

Complete independently to show what you learned today.

1. Self-assessment: in your own recent writing, do you tend to under-use evidence, under-use analysis, or both? Give one specific example from your own experience if possible.



Assessment · self-assessment

Rate today's work:

4 — I can teach this to someone else.

3 — I can do this independently.

2 — I can do this with help.

1 — I need to revisit this before the next session.



Answer key

1. Answers vary; e.g., "A lot of people use it every day" is missing a specific number, source, or time frame — the reader cannot verify or picture how many people or how often.
2. The claim is that the park deserves more funding because it matters to the community; it is difficult to find because it is repeated in different generalized phrasings ("really important," "means a lot," "deserves it") rather than stated once clearly and then supported.
3. Circular writing repeats a claim in different words instead of supporting it with new evidence; the "Before" paragraph restates "the park matters" four different ways (important, means a lot, sad if it fell into disrepair, deserves funding) without ever adding a specific supporting detail.
4. A city parks-department 2025 attendance report, and a short interview with local resident Maria Ibarra.
5. Answers vary; e.g., Evidence: "Riverside Park served an estimated 40,000 visitors last year..."; Analysis: "a facility serving 40,000 annual visitors carries a level of wear...that a city's general maintenance budget was never designed to absorb."

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Answer key

6. The lesson defines quote-dropping as citing evidence without analysis explaining how it proves the claim; the number alone shows usage but does not explain why heavy usage means the maintenance budget specifically needs more funding — the analysis sentence is what completes the connection to the claim.

7. Answers vary; must replace the vague claim with a specific, labeled hypothetical detail, e.g., "In a hypothetical survey of 50 students, 38 reported that fried items made up more than half of the entrée options over a two-week period."

8. A specific human story can create an emotional, concrete connection that a statistic alone does not; readers may relate more easily to one family's multigenerational experience than to an abstract number, even though the statistic demonstrates broader scale — strong paragraphs often use both types of evidence together.

9. Answers vary; must describe an imbalance, e.g., an all-statistics paragraph might feel cold or abstract and lose the human stakes, while an all-anecdote paragraph might feel unrepresentative or anecdotal without showing broader scale — a strong paragraph typically balances both.

10. Answers vary; must include a specific labeled hypothetical detail (e.g., a made-up but clearly labeled statistic or example) and a sentence explaining why that evidence supports the convenience claim specifically.

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Answer key

11. Answers vary; must select one sentence and justify the choice by naming specifically what information (number, source, example) is missing compared to the other vague sentences.

12. The topic sentence (the attendance figure) introduces the paragraph's central evidence-backed point, while the supporting sentences add further specific detail (the market, the league, the interview) and then analysis connecting all of it back to the funding claim.

13. This is quote-dropping (or the statistical equivalent of it) — evidence without analysis; adding statistics alone does not explain how or why that evidence supports the claim, which is required for a fully revised paragraph.

14. Answers vary; the original sentence must be a genuine generalization (vague, no specifics), and the revision must add a specific, clearly labeled hypothetical detail supporting it.

15. Answers vary; the analysis sentence must explicitly connect the evidence back to the claim, explaining the "why," not just restating the evidence.

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Answer key

16. The lesson states that revision is about replacing vague claims with specific evidence and analysis, not about length; a longer paragraph that is still full of generalizations has not actually been revised in the way the lesson describes.

17. The "Before" paragraph's final sentence restates the claim ("the city should give the park more funding") without new support; the "After" paragraph's final sentence provides genuine analysis, explicitly explaining why the scale of usage translates into a funding need — a stronger, more functional conclusion to the paragraph's argument.

18. Answers vary; must clearly distinguish evidence (a specific fact, quotation, or data point) from analysis (the writer's explanation of how that evidence supports a claim), illustrated with a new example.

19. Evidence alone shows something is true but does not explain why it matters to the claim; without analysis connecting the evidence back to the argument, a reader is left to guess the writer's reasoning, which weakens the paragraph's persuasive power even if the evidence itself is solid.

20. Answers vary; must reflect honestly and specifically on the student's own writing habits, naming evidence, analysis, or both as an area of growth.

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Access, sources, and license

Extension

Ask for a second method, a counterexample, or a short student-led extension of the concept, with a brief explanation of the choice.

Accommodated seating/504

Follow the individual accommodation plan: extended time, breaks, enlarged print, reduced copying, or an alternate response method as documented.

Additional support

Pre-teach key vocabulary or notation before class. Model the first guided item aloud. Accept oral or dictated responses when appropriate.

Multilingual learners

Preview key terms with examples. Allow brief first-language discussion before independent writing. Provide sentence or solution starters.

Course-level alignment • accessed September 18, 2026

COURSE-OBJ.ENGL101.2 — Revise a thesis-driven paragraph by replacing generalizations with specific evidence and explicit analysis connecting that evidence back to the claim. The objective is original wording describing a focused part of the course-level goal.

Course-level learning objective written for this packet; no accreditation, transfer credit, or universal course-equivalency is claimed.

Original reading(s)/worked examples, questions, and answer explanations. No textbook or copyrighted course material reproduced.

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